



N H <[REDACTED]@gmail.com>

Re: From the Office of Senator Suzette Martinez Valladares

1 message

- <[REDACTED]@gmail.com>

Sun, Jun 21, 2026 at 11:28 PM

To: Sydney.Hill@sen.ca.gov

Dear Ms. Hill,

I appreciate the quick response. Attached is the completed form with my signature.

Thank you

Nicolas Hernandez

On Sun, Jun 21, 2026 at 5:41 PM <Sydney.Hill@sen.ca.gov> wrote:

Dear Mr. Hernandez,

Thank you for contacting our office with your questions regarding your expedited outpatient transition. We know this is a difficult time and we want to get you the answers that you need.

In order to assist you we require a signed Authorization for a Release of Information, which I have attached. This form will allow us to reach out to the Department of Health Care Services to make an inquiry on your behalf.

Again, thank you for reaching out and if you have any additional questions, please let me know.

Sincerely,

Sydney Hill
Constituent Services Representative
Senator Suzette Valladares, 23rd District
42505 10th Street West, Ste 109
Lancaster, CA 93534
(661) 729-6232
WWW.SR23.SENATE.CA.GOV

 **Authorization for Release of Information..pdf**
1014K



N H <[REDACTED]@gmail.com>

Re: From the Office of Senator Suzette Martinez Valladares

1 message

- <[REDACTED]@gmail.com>
To: Sydney.Hill@sen.ca.gov

Wed, Jun 24, 2026 at 1:31 PM

Dear Ms. Hill,

I just spoke with Patrick at your office and wanted to do a quick follow up email.

Since your email noted that your office is assisting with my expedited outpatient transition, I wanted to provide an urgent update regarding the timeline. This transition involves a medically supervised benzodiazepine taper, making a predictable, uninterrupted care timeline absolutely critical to my physical health and safety.

Unfortunately, the standard administrative track has completely stalled. As of June 15, 2026, my state appeal passed its mandatory regulatory due date under both CDSS MPP Section 22-060.1 and federal regulation 42 CFR Section 431.244(f)(1). I have attached a clean screenshot from the State Appeals Case Management System (ACMS) for your reference, showing that the file remains stuck in "Pending Scheduling" despite the deadline passing.

Because the alternative administrative remedies have effectively collapsed due to this default, the formal Member Inquiry from Senator Valladares' office is the only lever available to break this logjam with the Department of Health Care Services (DHCS) and CDSS.

Thank you again for your time, empathy, and vital assistance in helping me resolve this safely.

Best regards,

Nicolas Hernandez

On Sun, Jun 21, 2026 at 11:28 PM - <[REDACTED]@gmail.com> wrote:

Dear Ms. Hill,

I appreciate the quick response. Attached is the completed form with my signature.

Thank you

Nicolas Hernandez

On Sun, Jun 21, 2026 at 5:41 PM <Sydney.Hill@sen.ca.gov> wrote:

Dear Mr. Hernandez,

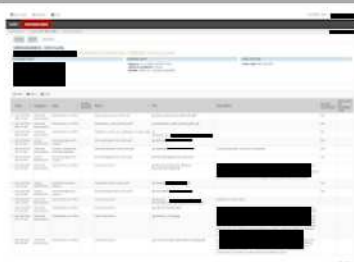
Thank you for contacting our office with your questions regarding your expedited outpatient transition. We know this is a difficult time and we want to get you the answers that you need.

In order to assist you we require a signed Authorization for a Release of Information, which I have attached. This form will allow us to reach out to the Department of Health Care Services to make an inquiry on your behalf.

Again, thank you for reaching out and if you have any additional questions, please let me know.

Sincerely,

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ACMS-portal-default-screenshot-Nicolas-Hernandez.png
394K



N H <[REDACTED]@gmail.com>

Re: From the Office of Senator Suzette Martinez Valladares

1 message

- <[REDACTED]@gmail.com>

Thu, Jun 25, 2026 at 11:43 PM

To: Sydney.Hill@sen.ca.gov

Dear Ms. Hill,

Thank you for the prompt follow-up and for coordinating with the DHCS legislative liaison on my behalf.

Please find attached the completed DHCS Release of Information (LGA Authorization) form.

For your records and DHCS's reference, the key facts of my case are as follows:

L.A. Care has failed to reimburse, contest, or issue written notice on a clean claim of \$2,307.00 submitted via the Conlan out-of-network reimbursement process within the statutory window. My packet was received by DHCS on March 27, 2026 via USPS certified mail. AB 3275 required written response by April 26, 2026 - none was issued. A Gainswell Technologies contractor contacted me by phone on June 4, 2026 (39 days past the statutory deadline) requesting superbills; one was already included in the original packet. Both were submitted by email on June 5, 2026. No written acknowledgment was received within the 2 working day requirement under 28 CCR § 1300.71(c) for electronic submissions - violation confirmed June 9, 2026. Interest has been accruing at 15% per annum since April 27, 2026.

Additionally, I want to flag that two separate DMHC complaints I filed - one regarding denial of covered transportation to pharmacy, and one requesting an Independent Medical Review (IMR) due to an urgent medication situation - were improperly merged into a single case by DMHC (DMHC#: [REDACTED]44). This merger has effectively converted a 3-day expedited IMR process into a standard 30-day review, during which I will exhaust my medication supply. I communicated this urgency to DMHC directly and it was not acted upon.

I am available by email for any follow-up questions.

Thank you so much again for your office's attention to this matter.

Sincerely,

Nicolas Hernandez

On Thu, Jun 25, 2026 at 3:02 PM <Sydney.Hill@sen.ca.gov> wrote:

Dear Mr. Hernandez,

Thank you again for contacting following up with our office concerning your regarding an expedited outpatient transition.

We have heard from our legislative liaison at the California Department of Health Care Services regarding the inquiry our office made on your behalf. DHCS acknowledges that this is urgent, so they want to make sure they have the necessary information to investigate immediately. For quick assistance, we will need your Medi-Cal ID number. This number can be found on your benefits ID card and begins with a 9. Once they have this, they can begin investigating.

DHCS also said they will need a DHCS Release of Information form from you in order to share updates with our office. (This is a DHCS form and is different than the form you completed for our office.) I have attached a template for your convenience. Please note: Without this form, the DHCS can still investigate your inquiry and can reach out to you directly for updates; this form authorizes them to continue to talk to our office.

Please feel free to contact our office if you have any further questions.

Sincerely,

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Nicolas Hernandez - LGA Authorization.pdf
1225K



N H <[REDACTED]@gmail.com>

Re: From the Office of Senator Suzette Martinez Valladares

1 message

- <[REDACTED]@gmail.com>

Fri, Jun 26, 2026 at 1:10 PM

To: Sydney.Hill@sen.ca.gov

Dear Ms. Hill,

My Medi-Cal ID number (from my BIC card) is 9 [REDACTED]

Please let me know if you need anything else.

Thank you.

Nicolas Hernandez

On Fri, Jun 26, 2026 at 12:08 PM <Sydney.Hill@sen.ca.gov> wrote:

Good morning,

Thank you for providing out office with the DHCS Authorrization form.

In order for DHCS to assist, they will need your Medi-Cal ID number. This number can be found on your benefits ID card and begins with a 9. Once we they have this, we can begin investigating and reach out to you for updates if necessary.

If you are not a Medi-Cal member, we will need to focus on working with DMHC since DHCS only has purview over Medi-Cal members.

Sincerely,

Sydney Hill
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N H <[REDACTED]@gmail.com>

Re: From the Office of Senator Suzette Martinez Valladares

1 message

- <[REDACTED]@gmail.com>

Mon, Jul 6, 2026 at 11:49 AM

To: Sydney.Hill@sen.ca.gov

Dear Ms. Hill,

I am following up on the email below. I sent over my Medi-Cal ID number ten days ago on June 26th so that your office could begin investigating this matter with DHCS.

Given the time-sensitive nature of this situation, I need an immediate update on where the investigation stands.

I look forward to hearing from you today.

Thank you,

Nicolas Hernandez

On Fri, Jun 26, 2026 at 12:08 PM <Sydney.Hill@sen.ca.gov> wrote:

Good morning,

Thank you for providing out office with the DHCS Authorrization form.

In order for DHCS to assist, they will need your Medi-Cal ID number. This number can be found on your benefits ID card and begins with a 9. Once we they have this, we can begin investigating and reach out to you for updates if necessary.

If you are not a Medi-Cal member, we will need to focus on working with DMHC since DHCS only has purview over Medi-Cal members.

Sincerely,

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N H <[REDACTED]@gmail.com>

From the Office of Senator Suzette Martinez Valladares

1 message

Sydney.Hill@sen.ca.gov <Sydney.Hill@sen.ca.gov>

Wed, Jul 15, 2026 at 3:40 PM

To: [REDACTED]@gmail.com

Dear Mr. Hernandez,

I just wanted to follow up with you concerning the inquiry we opened on your behalf with the DHCS.

We have been communicating with our legislative liaison, ensuring your updates are forwarded to the right people and that your concerns are addressed. We have been assured that they are finishing up their official response to our inquiry and will send it to us as soon as it is ready. Once we receive it, we will forward it to you.

We know this has been a difficult process and we appreciate your patience. Please feel free to contact our office if you have any further questions.

Sincerely,

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N H <[REDACTED]@gmail.com>

Re: From the Office of Senator Suzette Martinez Valladares

1 message

- <[REDACTED]@gmail.com>

Tue, Jul 21, 2026 at 11:29 AM

To: Sydney.Hill@sen.ca.gov

Dear Ms. Hill,

Thank you for the update. I want to be direct about where this stands from my end: it has now been over three weeks since I provided my Medi-Cal ID number (June 26) to allow DHCS to begin investigating, and nearly a month since your office first opened this inquiry (June 21). "Finishing up their official response" without a specific date doesn't give me anything I can act on, and this delay is directly affecting a time-sensitive medical situation - specifically an ongoing, medically supervised medication taper that depends on uninterrupted care access.

To help me understand where things actually stand, could you get me the following from the DHCS liaison:

1. A specific date by which DHCS's written response will be sent to your office.
2. The name and direct contact information of the DHCS staff member handling this inquiry, so I have someone to reference if further follow-up is needed.
3. Confirmation of whether DHCS is aware that my State Fair Hearing (SHN-105273296) missed its federal deadline under 42 CFR § 431.244(f) on June 15, 2026, and that I filed a Notice of Default with CDSS on June 16, since that appears to be the underlying cause of the delay across every channel I've tried.

If DHCS is unable to provide a concrete date, I'd appreciate knowing that too, so I can make an informed decision about next steps, including whether to pursue this through the California State Auditor's office or federal channels (CMS Region 9).

I recognize this isn't within your office's control, and I appreciate the follow-ups you've sent. I just need something more specific than "soon" at this point, given how long this has already taken.

Thank you,

Nicolas Hernandez

On Wed, Jul 15, 2026 at 3:40 PM <Sydney.Hill@sen.ca.gov> wrote:

Dear Mr. Hernandez,

I just wanted to follow up with you concerning the inquiry we opened on your behalf with the DHCS.

We have been communicating with our legislative liaison, ensuring your updates are forwarded to the right people and that your concerns are addressed. We have been assured that they are finishing up their official response to our inquiry and will send it to us as soon as it is ready. Once we receive it, we will forward it to you.

We know this has been a difficult process and we appreciate your patience. Please feel free to contact our office if you have any further questions.

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